

Letter from the Executive Board

Greetings Delegates,

I warmly welcome you to this simulation of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) at Cornerstone MUN 2026. As an ardent fan of the sport myself, I am confident that each one of you will have an enriching experience at the conference, regardless of your prior MUN experience or familiarity with cricket administration.

One thing I'd like you to keep in mind as you step into this committee is that you are no longer representing diplomats, parliamentarians, or political leaders. Instead, you are stepping into the shoes of some of the most influential stakeholders in Indian cricket. In this committee, your decisions will not be guided by foreign policy or party ideology, but by what you believe is best for the game, its stakeholders, and the millions of cricket fans across the country.

Every decision taken within this committee has the potential to shape not only the future of cricket in India but also the manner in which Indian cricket is perceived on the global stage. While all stakeholders represented here ultimately seek the growth and success of the sport, each portfolio brings its own priorities, responsibilities, and perspective on how that objective should be achieved.

This Background Guide is intended to provide you with the foundational knowledge required to begin your preparation, focusing on the most essential aspects of the agenda. However, meaningful research beyond this document will be crucial in enabling you to understand the nuances of the committee and distinguish yourself during debate.

Should you have any queries regarding committee procedure, documentation, the agenda, or any other aspect of the simulation, please feel free to reach out to me. I would be more than happy to assist you.

I wish you all the very best with your preparation and look forward to meeting each of you at Cornerstone MUN 2026.

Best Regards,

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Committee Overview, History and Mandate

History of the BCCI

The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) was established in 1928 with the objective of organizing and administering cricket within India. Formed by representatives of regional cricket associations, the Board was created to provide a unified structure for the governance of the sport and to represent Indian cricket at the international level. Shortly after its establishment, the BCCI secured membership in the Imperial Cricket Conference (now the International Cricket Council), enabling India to participate in official international cricket competitions.

Over the decades, the BCCI played a central role in expanding the reach of cricket across the country. Through the establishment of domestic tournaments such as the Ranji Trophy and later the Duleep Trophy and Vijay Hazare Trophy, the Board created pathways for talented cricketers to progress from the domestic circuit to the national stage. The growth of cricket's popularity, coupled with India's increasing success in international competitions, gradually elevated the influence of the BCCI within the global cricketing community.

The turn of the twenty-first century marked a significant transformation in the Board's role and stature. The commercialization of cricket, the emergence of lucrative broadcasting rights, and the launch of the Indian Premier League (IPL) in 2008 greatly expanded the scale of the BCCI's operations. As revenues increased and Indian cricket became a major driver of the sport's global economy, the Board emerged as one of the most influential sporting organizations in the world.

In recent years, the BCCI has undergone several structural and administrative reforms aimed at improving governance, accountability, and transparency. Following recommendations arising from judicial and administrative reviews, the Apex Council was established as the principal decision-making body of the Board. Today, the BCCI continues to oversee the administration of domestic and international cricket in India while addressing new challenges relating to governance, player welfare, technological developments, commercial interests, and the evolving nature of the sport itself.

Mandate of the BCCI

The BCCI serves as the apex governing body responsible for the administration, regulation, and development of cricket in India. As the recognized national cricket board, it oversees all major aspects of the sport, ranging from grassroots

development and domestic competitions to the management of the Indian national teams and international cricketing engagements.

The BCCI's mandate extends beyond the organization of tournaments and matches. It is entrusted with formulating policies and regulations that govern the conduct of players, officials, franchises, and other stakeholders associated with the game. Through its various committees and administrative bodies, the Board establishes disciplinary frameworks, safeguards the integrity of competitions, and ensures that cricket in India is conducted in a fair, professional, and transparent manner.

In addition to governance and regulation, the BCCI is responsible for promoting the growth of cricket across the country. This includes supporting state cricket associations, developing infrastructure, nurturing emerging talent, expanding opportunities in women's cricket, and ensuring the long-term sustainability of the sport. The Board also represents Indian cricket at the international level and plays a significant role in shaping discussions concerning the future of the game globally.

Given its position as one of the most influential cricketing institutions in the world, the BCCI bears the responsibility of balancing the interests of players, administrators, commercial stakeholders, and millions of cricket fans. Consequently, the Board is expected not only to manage the sport effectively but also to uphold its values, protect its reputation, and adapt its policies to address emerging challenges within an increasingly interconnected and digital sporting landscape.

Delegates should note that the Apex Council cannot amend Indian criminal law, direct ICC policy, or impose obligations upon private social media companies beyond those permissible under existing legal and contractual frameworks. Proposed solutions should therefore remain within the institutional authority of the BCCI while recognising opportunities for cooperation with other stakeholders.

Powers and Responsibilities of the Apex Council Members

The Apex Council functions as the highest decision-making body within the BCCI and is responsible for overseeing the administration, governance, and development of cricket in India. While the President and Vice-President provide leadership to the Council, the remaining members play equally important roles in ensuring the efficient functioning of the Board.

Secretary

The Secretary serves as the chief executive and administrative officer of the BCCI. The office is responsible for implementing the decisions of the Apex Council, managing correspondence, coordinating with state cricket associations, and overseeing the day-to-day affairs of the Board. The Secretary has significant influence in setting administrative priorities, supervising committees, and ensuring

compliance with BCCI regulations. Owing to the nature of the position, the Secretary is often the primary link between the Board, players, franchises, and external stakeholders.

Joint Secretary

The Joint Secretary assists the Secretary in carrying out administrative functions and acts as a supporting authority in matters relating to governance and coordination. The office is responsible for facilitating communication between various committees and stakeholders, monitoring the implementation of Board policies, and assisting in the management of tournaments and developmental programs. In the absence of the Secretary, the Joint Secretary may also undertake several administrative responsibilities on behalf of the Board.

Treasurer

The Treasurer is entrusted with managing the financial affairs of the BCCI. This includes preparing and overseeing budgets, monitoring expenditures, maintaining financial records, and ensuring transparency in the Board's financial operations. The Treasurer plays a crucial role in determining the financial feasibility of policies and initiatives proposed by the Apex Council. Decisions involving investments, developmental projects, disciplinary expenditures, and funding allocations are often scrutinized through a financial lens by the Treasurer.

Councillor

The Councillor serves as the BCCI's representative in the International Cricket Council (ICC) and acts as a vital link between Indian cricket administration and the global governing framework of the sport. The office is responsible for representing the interests of the BCCI in international discussions, communicating developments within the ICC to the Apex Council, and ensuring that the Board remains informed about global cricketing policies and regulatory changes.

Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) Nominee

The CAG Nominee serves as an independent member of the Apex Council with the primary responsibility of promoting transparency, accountability, and good governance within the functioning of the BCCI. Unlike other members who may represent specific cricketing or administrative interests, the CAG Nominee is expected to provide an objective perspective on matters relating to financial management, regulatory compliance, and institutional integrity.

The CAG Nominee may also raise concerns regarding conflicts of interest, deficiencies in oversight mechanisms, or policies that could adversely affect the credibility of the institution. Through participation in discussions and voting, the CAG Nominee contributes to ensuring that the decisions of the Apex Council are not only

effective but also transparent, responsible, and consistent with the standards expected of one of the world's most influential sporting bodies.

Representative of the Indian Cricketers' Association (ICA)

The ICA Representative is responsible for advocating the interests of professional cricketers and ensuring that their rights and welfare remain a consideration in the Board's decision-making process. The representative contributes to discussions involving player conduct, grievance redressal mechanisms, welfare schemes, retirement benefits, and broader governance reforms affecting current and former players.

Collectively, these members possess the authority to formulate and amend regulations, establish committees, oversee disciplinary and governance matters, approve developmental initiatives, allocate resources, and adopt measures necessary for the advancement and administration of cricket in India. All major decisions of the Apex Council are taken through deliberation, consensus-building, and voting among its members.

The changing landscape of cricket in today's world

The modern cricket landscape is no longer just a sporting arena; it is a multi-billion-dollar global entertainment ecosystem. Propelled by the explosive ascent of franchise cricket, the sport has undergone a rapid paradigm shift. The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) no longer merely regulates a traditional game; it commands a sports empire driven by primetime television rights, algorithmic social media trends, and round-the-clock media scrutiny. However, all of this calls for urgent deliberation on one point in particular. As young athletes are thrust into the global limelight earlier than ever before, the BCCI faces an institutional crisis: the need to formulate a modernized code of conduct targeting on-field altercations and enforcing digital accountability.

Franchise leagues like the IPL have fundamentally rearranged a player's psychological and financial landscape. Breakout performances by uncapped prodigies now result in life-changing multi-crore contracts overnight. While this democratic distribution of wealth is revolutionary, it heightens competitive stress. In franchise cricket, every ball is a metric affecting market value.

This hyper-monetized environment heavily rewards raw aggression, frequently causing emotions to spill over into aggressive on-field altercations. The classic ICC Code of Conduct—which largely relies on standard match-fee fines—no longer deters athletes earning immense salaries. When a single over can dictate a player's social media stock, traditional financial penalties become minor operational expenses.

The growing popularity of social media platforms worsens the situation. Today's young cricketers perform beneath the relentless gaze of 4K broadcast cameras, hyper-analytical fan channels, and algorithmic social media feeds. Every micro-expression or aggressive gesture is instantly clipped and weaponized by online fanbases.

For young players, this creates a dangerous feedback loop. Because social media algorithms favor conflict, a heated on-field confrontation can cause a player's digital engagement to soar. When toxic behavior is rewarded with digital capital, traditional cricket etiquette is easily compromised. Furthermore, young players entering this ecosystem often lack the media literacy and emotional maturity to manage such situations, leaving them vulnerable to public relations disasters and intense mental fatigue.

Some notable instances of player aggression and social media abuse in domestic and international Cricket

1. The Virat Kohli vs. Gautam Gambhir On-Field Feuds (2013 & 2023)

Two of Indian cricket's biggest icons, Virat Kohli and Gautam Gambhir, were involved in highly animated, aggressive on-field verbal altercations during the Indian Premier League (IPL). The first notable clash happened in 2013 during a match between Royal Challengers Bangalore (RCB) and Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR). Exactly ten years later, in 2023, a similar heated confrontation took place when Gambhir was mentoring the Lucknow Super Giants.

During both these instances, both of them were fined 100% of their match fees but doing so for the first time couldn't prevent a second such incident.

2. The Mohammed Shami Online Abuse Incident (2021)

Following India's 10-wicket loss to Pakistan in the 2021 ICC Men's T20 World Cup, senior Indian fast bowler Mohammed Shami was subjected to severe, targeted online abuse. Trolls flooded his personal Instagram account with thousands of toxic comments, questioning his patriotism and targeting his religious identity. Though such allegations may seem baseless and illogical on the outset, they highlight how quick flames spread when incidents take place in the world of Cricket, especially in India.

3. Social Media Abuse and the 2026 IPL Racial Discrimination Controversy on Arshdeep Singh

Arshdeep Singh has been involved in two of the most widely discussed incidents highlighting the impact of social media and discrimination in cricket. During the 2022 Asia Cup, he dropped a crucial catch against Pakistan in the Super Four stage, after which India lost the match. Despite his overall strong performances, Arshdeep was subjected to widespread online abuse, hateful messages, and personal attacks. The International Cricket Council, the Board of Control for Cricket in India, former cricketers, and fans strongly condemned the cyberbullying and called for greater respect towards players.

In contrast, during the 2026 Indian Premier League, Arshdeep found himself at the centre of controversy after a viral video allegedly showed him making a colourist remark towards Tilak Varma. The incident sparked widespread criticism, with many describing the comment as racially insensitive and calling for disciplinary action. The controversy generated extensive debate on social media about racism, colourism, and player conduct in cricket, while Arshdeep himself also became the target of significant online abuse. Together, these incidents demonstrate how social media can amplify both player victimisation and accountability, making online behaviour and public reactions an increasingly important issue in modern cricket.

4. The Shubman Gill Social Media Umpiring Fine (2023)

During his early domestic career in a 2020 Ranji Trophy match for Punjab against Delhi, Gill refused to walk off the pitch after being given caught-behind by the umpire. He had a heated on-field argument with the umpire, resulting in the decision being overturned, which prompted Delhi players to threaten to leave the field in protest. He was ultimately fined 100 percent of his match fee for dissent. During the 2023 ICC World Test Championship Final against Australia, young Indian opener Shubman Gill was dismissed via a highly controversial catch by Cameron Green. After the day's play, a frustrated Gill took to his personal social media accounts (X and Instagram) to post a screenshot of the catch with magnifying glass emojis, subtly criticizing the third umpire's decision. Later on, he was fined 15% of his match fee by the ICC itself but that didn't mean that more such cases did not take place in his career as a cricketer later on.

5. The India vs. Bangladesh U-19 World Cup Final Altercation (2020)

Immediately after Bangladesh defeated India in a tense, high-stakes 2020 ICC U-19 Cricket World Cup Final in South Africa, players from both teams clashed aggressively on the field. Several Bangladeshi players ran onto the pitch to celebrate, exchanging physical shoves and heated words with the visibly devastated Indian cricketers. The situation escalated quickly into an ugly physical scuffle, forcing match officials and coaches to step in to separate the teenagers.

Following an investigation, the ICC found several Indian and Bangladeshi U-19 players guilty of breaching the Code of Conduct for behavior that "brought the game into disrepute." For the BCCI, this incident highlighted that aggressive on-field behavior is deep-seated at the junior levels, emphasizing that strict disciplinary boundaries must be taught early in a player's development cycle rather than waiting until they reach senior international cricket.

6. The Vaibhav Suryavanshi Post-Match and Deepfake Controversies (2026)

A recent incident that has taken to the news really fast. At just 15 years old, batting prodigy Vaibhav Suryavanshi faced immense pressure after a meteoric rise in domestic cricket and the IPL. During an India A tour, emotions boiled over when Suryavanshi lost his cool and was involved in a heated post-match physical push and verbal altercation with a Sri Lankan player. Compounding his challenges, a heavily manipulated "deepfake" video surfaced on social media falsely showing him insulting senior Indian legend Virat Kohli, which led to widespread organic fan outrage and severe online trolling. This incident highlights a new frontier of digital vulnerability, showing how young players can become victims of malicious internet trends that damage their reputation before their careers even fully begin.

Existing Legal Frameworks that seek to prevent clashes on-field and social media abuse

The BCCI and ICC Codes of Conduct

The BCCI Code of Conduct for Players and Team Officials (which largely mirrors the ICC Code of Conduct) functions as the primary disciplinary framework during matches. Violations are categorized into four distinct levels of severity:

- **Level 1 & 2 Offences** (Verbal and Gestural Altercations): Articles 2.3 (Audible Obscenity), 2.5 (Provoking a batter upon dismissal), and 2.13 (Personal Abuse) are designed to curb "sledging" and hostile face-offs. Level 1 covers

minor heat-of-the-moment profanities, while Level 2 deals with direct, serious personal insults.

- **Level 3 & 4 Offences** (Physical Clashes & Intimidation): Articles 2.12 (Inappropriate Physical Contact), 2.18 (Physical Assault), and 2.19 (Acts of Violence) govern physical altercations. Level 4 offences carry the strictest sporting penalties, including life bans.
- **The "Spirit of Cricket"** (Article 2.20): This serves as an all-encompassing clause for any unsporting behavior that does not explicitly fall under a defined article but brings the game into disrepute.

While on-field sports injuries or standard verbal disputes are generally handled internally by sports tribunals via the principle of implied consent (*volenti non fit injuria*), extreme physical violence on the pitch transcends sports regulatory bodies. In extreme cases, actions can be prosecuted under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) for criminal intimidation, voluntary hurt, or assault.

Digital Accountability and Social Media Abuse

As young cricketers enter high-stakes environments like the IPL and domestic circuits, they face severe external cyberbullying, coordinated trolling, and occasionally, their own lapses in digital decorum. Accountability here is governed by a mix of corporate athlete management guidelines and Indian cyber laws.

Sports Governance Frameworks

- **Public Statements and Media Clauses:** Under **Article 2.7** of the BCCI Code, players are prohibited from making public criticisms of match incidents, umpires, or fellow players on social media.
- **Bringing the Game into Disrepute (Article 2.21):** This article is increasingly invoked to penalize players for inappropriate, offensive, or controversial digital behavior outside of match hours, ensuring that their online footprint aligns with the sport's commercial and ethical standards.
- **Contractual Mandates:** Modern central and franchise contracts contain strict social media riders that require young players to undergo mandatory media training and limit the types of digital content they can interact with or post.

Indian Cyber and Penal Laws

When players become targets of severe online abuse, harassment, or extortion, or if they participate in defamatory online behavior, the following statutory laws apply:

- **The Information Technology (IT) Act:**
 - **Section 66D:** Punishes cheating by personation using computer resources (often invoked in cases of fake player profiles used for scams or targeted harassment).

- **Section 67:** Prohibits publishing or transmitting obscene material in electronic form.
- **The Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS):**
 - **Section 356 (Defamation):** Applicable when online abuse crosses into systematic character assassination affecting a player's livelihood or mental well-being.
 - **Section 79:** Specifically penalizes words, gestures, or acts intended to insult the modesty of a woman—critical for protecting the rapidly growing ecosystem of young women cricketers from targeted online misogyny.
- **IT (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules:** These rules legally bind social media platforms (intermediaries) to swiftly take down abusive, defamatory, or non-consensual content targeting individuals when reported.

The Financial Stakes of On-Field Clashes and Social Media Misuse

In modern cricket, player behavior is directly linked to the sport's massive economic value. With the BCCI generating unprecedented domestic and global revenue, a player is no longer just an athlete; they are a prime asset in a multi-billion-dollar commercial ecosystem. Unchecked on-field aggression and digital misconduct have severe financial ramifications that affect broadcasting agreements, franchise equity, and player marketability.

The primary engine of Indian cricket's wealth is its media rights.

- **Per-Match Valuation:** Under the BCCI's media rights structures, a single Indian Premier League (IPL) match holds an estimated valuation of over **₹100 Crore (\$13.4 million)**, trailing only the NFL globally in per-match worth. Bilateral home internationals fetch roughly **₹67.8 Crore per match**.
- **The Advertiser Liability:** Broadcasters pay these massive premiums based on predictable, family-friendly entertainment windows that appeal to prime-time consumers. When an on-field altercation turns ugly—involving audible profanities or physical intimidation—it directly threatens advertiser goodwill. Brands are highly sensitive to "contextual risk"; associative toxicity during a broadcast can lead to immediate pull-outs or renegotiated ad-rates, leaving networks legally vulnerable.

Under the IPL model, teams operate as corporate franchises with private equity valuations reaching close to **\$1.5 billion to \$2 billion** per team.

- **Sponsor Attrition:** Front-of-jersey and principal sponsors tie their corporate identity directly to a team's cultural image. When players engage in toxic social media feuds or exhibit volatile behavior on-field, sponsors face public relations backlashes.
- **The Cost of Disciplinary Bans:** When a marquee player receives a multi-match ban under the Code of Conduct, the franchise suffers a direct blow to its competitive output. Because team valuations are closely tied to playoff qualification and central revenue distributions (prize money pools), a single player's lack of self-control can result in losses worth tens of crores for the franchise owners.

For young, emerging cricketers, digital or on-field misconduct carries immediate, devastating personal financial consequences.

Match-Fee Deductions

Under Article 7 of the BCCI disciplinary system, Level 1 and Level 2 offences result in an immediate forfeiture of up to **100% of a player's match fees** for that game. For a player on a lucrative match-tier contract, multiple infractions can wipe out an entire season's earnings.

Corporate Morality Clauses

Every major commercial endorsement contract today features a strict **"Morality Clause."** These legal provisions grant corporations the unilateral right to instantly terminate a contract or claw back paid advances if an athlete behaves in a way that brings public disrepute, scandal, or ridicule upon themselves or the brand.

Hence, face-offs such as those seen in recent days are not just detrimental for the concerned player's brand image but are equally harmful for the various stakeholders in the world of cricket.

Questions a Resolution must address

- How will the new code of conduct clearly differentiate between acceptable competitive gamesmanship and malicious personal attacks?
- What mandatory restrictions or guidelines must be enforced regarding the personal social media accounts of contracted and domestic players?
- How should the BCCI penalize players who use digital platforms or live streams to fuel ongoing player-versus-player feuds or criticize match officials?

- Where should the BCCI draw the boundary between a player's right to personal expression and their obligation to uphold the brand integrity of Indian cricket?
- What specific mandatory digital literacy and media training modules must be integrated into academy and Under-19 structures to prepare young cricketers for sudden fame?
- Should young and uncapped players be subject to stricter digital monitoring or mentorship-backed social media clauses during active tournament windows?
- How can senior players, captains, and franchise coaching staff be held contractually or financially accountable for failing to de-escalate altercations involving junior players?
- What legal or contractual mechanisms are required to ensure that independent IPL franchises strictly enforce BCCI-mandated penalties without seeking loopholes for star players?
- How will the BCCI balance its internal Code of Conduct with overlapping International Cricket Council regulations during multi-board or international fixtures?